

B1 Reading

Academic diagnostic - Reading

Level	B1 - Intermediate Academic
Skills assessed	Reading, Listening, Writing, Speaking, Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Format	Academic entrance diagnostic test

Reading

Why confidence is not the same as comfort

When Sofia joined an online English group, she expected the lessons to feel easier than school. She imagined that speaking from her room would be less stressful than speaking in front of classmates. The first lesson proved the opposite. Because the group was small, the teacher asked everyone to respond several times. Sofia knew many grammar rules, but she paused whenever she had to express a personal opinion.

After a month, she noticed a pattern. Her problem was not a lack of knowledge; it was the habit of waiting until a sentence was perfect. The teacher began giving tasks with time limits: thirty seconds to prepare, one minute to speak, and then a short correction. Sofia still made mistakes, but she became more willing to try. By the end of the course, she understood that confidence grows through repeated controlled difficulty, not through avoiding uncomfortable tasks.

01 What did Sofia expect before joining the group?

- A. The teacher would ignore her.
 - B. Online lessons would feel easier.
 - C. There would be no speaking.
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02 Why was the first lesson difficult?

- A. The internet failed.
 - B. Everyone had to respond several times.
 - C. The text was too long.
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03	What was Sofia's real problem? A. Not knowing any grammar. B. Waiting for perfect sentences. C. Refusing to do homework. _____
04	What kind of tasks did the teacher introduce? A. Only translation tasks. B. Timed speaking tasks. C. Silent reading tasks. _____
05	What changed by the end? A. She stopped making mistakes completely. B. Sofia became more willing to try. C. She left the group. _____
06	What does controlled difficulty mean here? A. A task with no help. B. A challenge with structure and support. C. An exam with no time limit. _____
07	Which statement is closest to the main idea? A. Comfort is always the best learning condition. B. Confidence develops through practice under pressure. C. Grammar rules are unnecessary. _____

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What can be inferred about the teacher?

- A. The teacher disliked mistakes.
 - B. The teacher used pressure carefully.
 - C. The teacher avoided feedback.
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